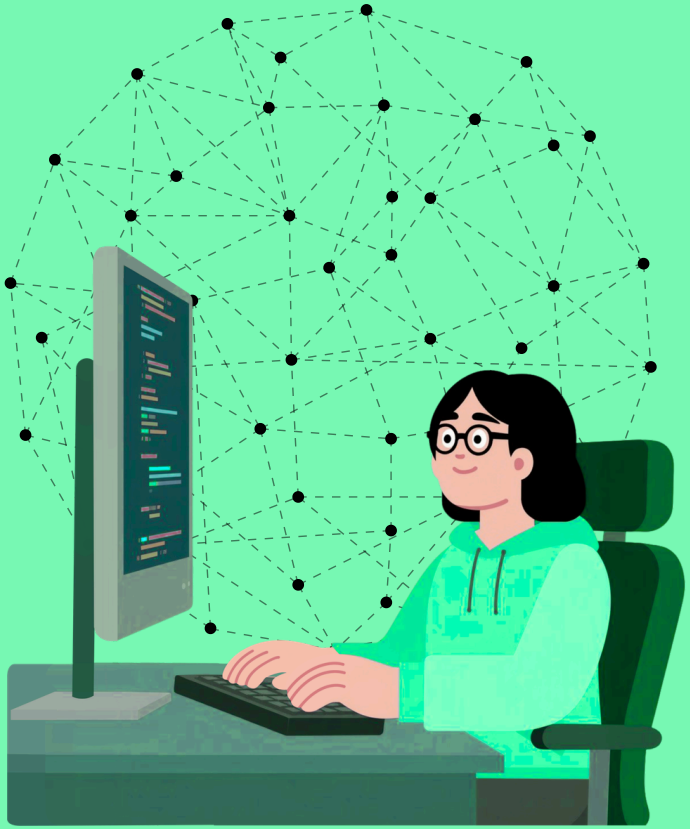
Foss Artificial Intelligence



What is FOSS?

Foss is an acronym for **F**ree and **O**pen **S**ource **S**oftware. This is software and programs that anyone can view the source code of, and can modify or use it for free.

Trump directs US agencies to toss Anthropic's AI as Pentagon calls startup a supply risk

By Andrea Shalal, Jeffrey Dastin and Ryan Patrick Jones

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U.S. President Donald Trump walks to depart from the White House, ahead of his trip to Corpus Christi, Texas, in Washington, D.C., U.S., February 27, 2026. REUTERS/Evelyn Hockstein Purchase Licensing Rights

AI in modern day

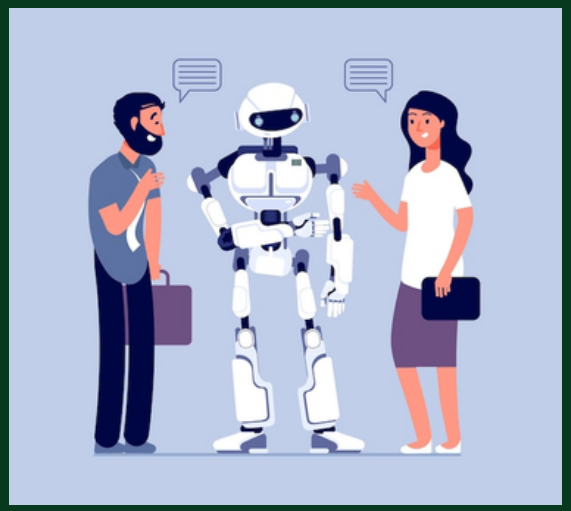
Unless you've been living under a rock, everyone has seen the impact of AI and how it has been shaping the world. The most powerful AI is being used to build platforms, make huge life changing decisions, make changes in the economy, and by students like you to do their homework. Currently it is replacing our modern infrastructure, who owns this powerful technology?

AI for surveillance

- Currently in the hands of private companies
- Trained using people's information and art without permission
- People don't know how sensitive personal information can be and has been used
- The U.S. government attempted to pressure Anthropic to remove safeguards limiting military uses of its AI; when the company refused, officials moved to blacklist it from government technology supply chains.

https://www.reuters.com/world/us/trump-says-he-is-directing-federal-agencies-cease-use-anthropic-technology-2026-02-27/?

“Anthropic understands that the Department of War, not private companies, makes military decisions,” but AI in narrow cases “can undermine, rather than defend, democratic values,” - Amodei
(CEO of Anthropic)



how can open source improve the future of ai?

Technology is always better when everyone partakes and contributes to it. Open source projects such as Linux have thrived for so long because of it’s contributors and the community. Open source technology puts control and power back in the hands of the users, it allows for the technology to be transparent about what information is gathered from the user and how it’s processed. Not to mention ethical concerns with how AI is currently being built. Apart from this everyone should have a say in how this technology is used. Instead of mass surveillance or warfare, it can be used democratically to help it’s community.

References

[1] S. J. Russell and P. Norvig, Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach, 3rd ed. Upper Saddle

[2] D. Vake, B. Šinik, J. Vičič, and A. Tošić, "Is Open Source the Future of AI? A Data-Driven Approach," Applied Sciences, vol. 15, no. 5, art. no. 2790, Mar. 2025

Thanks

for reading

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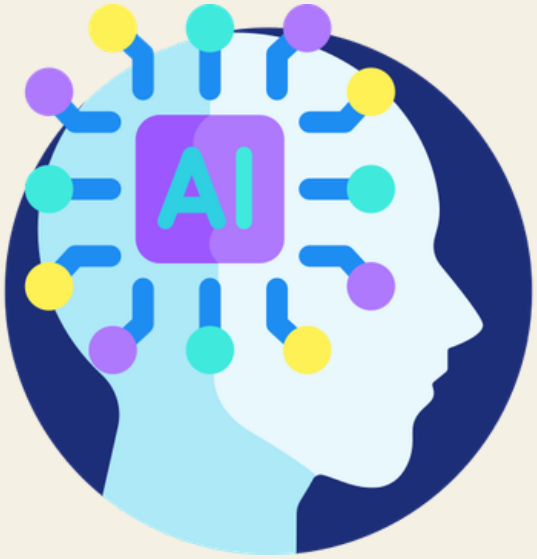

What is FOSS?

Foss is an acronym for **F**ree and **O**pen **S**ource **S**oftware. Open source means that anybody can access and modify and in most cases also redistribute this modified software for free. Open source software has changed the way that technology adapts and improves, as well as collaboration. It allows tech to be transparent to users in what it does and therefore it's very trustworthy.

FOSS also tends to improve software. Although most of these projects don't tend to have the resources or funding that private companies do, often the large community around these are driven by pure passion and collaboration. As a result FOSS tends to be pretty reliable under the right community.

Examples include Blender which is a 3d rendering software, which is becoming an industry standard and has remarkable features and optimized workflow. Another example would be GNU/LINUX. GNU/LINUX is a FOSS operating system which is used worldwide for professional servers, to embedded systems, and in personal machines.

AI for mass surveillance and warfare?

Recently the American government has pressured the AI company Anthropic into handing over it's AI system without any restrictions. Due to the American governments recent actions, it's not far fetched to think that they want to use it for mass surveillance and harmful military activities. These were the concerns expressed by the CEO of Anthropic as he refused. Since the refusal the American government has cut off all ongoing business with them and labeled them a supply chain risk. It won't be long until another AI company is up for the task to fulfill the governments wishes.

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What is the role of FOSS?

When technology is free and open source it puts power back in the hands of it’s users as opposed to private corporations or governments which get to make all the decisions and have complete oversight in its development.

AI has already been integrating with military and warfare, the IDF uses technology supplied by the company PALANTIR to select targets. Often these systems do not have any human oversight and democratic values, or human lives are completely looked over.

AI in itself poses huge ethical questions, and it being solely in the hands of corporations does not help this. It’s currently being used and trained for actions that masses completely disagree with, the opposite of democracy.

Sources

[1] S. J. Russell and P. Norvig, Artificial Intelligence: A Modern Approach, 3rd ed. Upper Saddle

[2] D. Vake, B. Šinik, J. Vičič, and A. Tošić, "Is Open Source the Future of AI? A Data-Driven Approach," Applied Sciences, vol. 15, no. 5, art. no. 2790, Mar. 2025

[3] https://www.972mag.com/lavender-ai-israeli-army-gaza/